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***Research Proposal on- Change of Communication System
among Older Generation in Dhaka by Using Facebook***

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Change of communication system among older generation in Dhaka by using Facebook

1. Introduction

1.1. Focus Idea-

The *focus* of the research is to see a change of communication system from the view of an older adult's perspective. This would help them to know their feelings about it in more detail and we will know how it happened and still happening and also, can solve several problems which they are facing because of the new change. And if we want to know about it more deeply, we have to communicate by being close and comfortable to them. By following this type of method, we can try to achieve our main goal. And this research is important because by doing it properly, we can help in seeing a social change. This research will be successful research if we follow proper methodology, manage time and budget nicely and study more about other researches done previously similar to the topic.

1.2. Background-

Actually, we precisely want to talk about the **change** of communication among older generations. Because we saw many differences about how our generation uses Facebook and how our parents use it. By seeing our parents using it, we got inspired to research about the topic and want to see the change of communication system among their generation. We already know a lot about how our generation is getting used to it and many other terms but, we actually do not study much about how they see it, how they are taking and acting to this kind of communication change. Also, are they seeing more positive sides than negative about using it or not?

"A few years ago, it was already declared that social networking sites had "matured" to the "age-neutral" stage where individuals, young or old, used social networking sites in their daily lives." (Stroud, 2008).¹

So, we can discuss the changes in just our older generation and how they are consuming the social change. The research will be just inside **Dhaka** because we think it will be easier to get information because most of our connections with elders are in Dhaka.

And also, we will discuss only about **Facebook** because most of them who use social media use Facebook more than other apps. They are more attracted to this app than others.

¹ <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3358790/>

There are several reasons that why are they mostly attracted to Facebook than other apps-

1. Easy to reach friends who they have not met for a very long time or those friends who live across the country.

“However, through the use of Facebook, senior citizens are able to remain socially connected.”² (Rylands & Belle, 2018)

2. It is easier to use than other apps because most of the things are easier to attract on them Facebook than other apps. It can grab attention easily and understands what the user actually wants to see. They notify and bring those things to the user which they desire.

3. Most of the Facebook users who we are talking about are mostly attracted to- live videos about several products, short video of series or drama and most of them contact via call or video rather than chatting. These things made their communication system easy and unique for them. Many of them find many things more easily reachable than other ways.

“In terms of features used on Facebook, the results indicate that the respondents used only a limited set of features such as the like button, commenting on other Facebook users’ activities, birthday notifications, messaging people, writing posts on a wall and uploading pictures.”³ (Rylands & Belle, 2018)

1.3. The reasons behind choosing the topic-

The reason behind choosing this topic is that we are seeing a huge communication change among our parents in the past few years. So, we got interested in knowing how this happened in their generation and what kind of changes they are facing from their perspective.

For our case, we saw our parents getting involved in using social media very quickly and also seeing several impacts on them. How are they taking these changes, how is it giving them a scope to enjoy their leisure time and not giving chance to loneliness, how can we help them with the problems they are facing and also the problem they are not seeing as a problem.

Loneliness and social isolation negatively impact overall health, especially for people at later stages in life, (Hanfer, 2016; Nutt, 2016), which merits the attention placed on how social benefits can be derived from technology and social media engagement. This connection has spotlighted the ways in which social technologies can reduce loneliness among older adults.

² https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-319-59111-7_60?fbclid=IwAR1Hueyuxbn95JPeXG69IbImY7PLiGFqHWcTyJH4B5pCf0wOO9HdCBUSYN4

³ https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-319-59111-7_60?fbclid=IwAR1Hueyuxbn95JPeXG69IbImY7PLiGFqHWcTyJH4B5pCf0wOO9HdCBUSYN4

(Baecker, Sellen, Crosskey, Boscart, & Barbosa Neves, 2014; Sinclair & Grieve, 2017)⁴

Few years ago, our parents' communication system was not like the way it is today. After cell phones came, they used to communicate via cell phone. Then another big change happened when it became more digitalized. Most of them saw how we are creating social networks through social media. So many of them got interested in using it too and many of them want us to introduce it. After that they get used to networking through social media and encourage their close ones. And like this a social change in communication happened in the past few years.

“Senior citizens are influenced by their social peers and members of their family, particularly their children and grandchildren who play the role of change agents in creating awareness and ultimately the use of the technology.”⁵(Rylands & Belle, 2018)

We are actually pretty amazed how they are enjoying using social media and making their lives easy as we made it easy. From this fascination we want to know about their change and how they are taking this change. We noticed positive and negative impacts equally.

For example- they are expressing their creativity in cooking, sharing Islamic articles with us, getting attached with some of their childhood friends after so long, getting interested in taking pictures again and posting them etc.

“The respondents perceived, on average, that Facebook allowed them to increase their educational resources, health resources (by finding out about health issues), social resources (connect better with existing friends and family; find new friends), saved time and allowed them to tap into the cultural newsworthy happenings and events in their local community as well as global world.”⁶ (Rylands & Belle, 2018)

Also some negative impacts- sometimes they cannot control themselves from using it too much, cannot judge authentic or fake news etc.

“They are using social media on daily basis and we observe they are becoming addicted to social media.”⁷(Zaman, Shoshi, & Nakib, 2021)

“Social media sensation is increased in the pandemic of COVID-19 lockdown.”⁸ (Zaman, Shoshi, & Nakib, 2021)

⁴ <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/2056305118787203>

⁵ https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-319-59111-7_60?fbclid=IwAR1Hueyuxbn95JPeXG69IbImY7PLiGFqHwCTyJH4B5pCf0wOO9HdCBUSYN4

⁶ https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-319-59111-7_60?fbclid=IwAR1Hueyuxbn95JPeXG69IbImY7PLiGFqHwCTyJH4B5pCf0wOO9HdCBUSYN4

⁷ <http://dspace.daffodilvarsity.edu.bd:8080/handle/123456789/7463>

⁸ <http://dspace.daffodilvarsity.edu.bd:8080/handle/123456789/7463>

“They are becoming so much addicted to social media that if they see any news or any information on social media they are believing it. This can be very bad as much information in social media can be false leading.”⁹ (Zaman, Shoshi, & Nakib, 2021)

So, we can observe the impact very closely, for example, the scopes and problems they are facing. And by these we think we can work about this topic and will enjoy doing research about it.

1.4. Research Objectives-

- 1) Knowing the change of communication system of the older generation from the last 5-10 years, their feelings about the change, their own experiences, positive or negative sides. Can discuss their perception and era.
- 2) We want to see the change in the communication system and their feelings about the change.
- 3) We can accomplish social, behavioral, and communication changes.
- 4) By doing this research, we can understand our generational differences and try to do better about them.
- 5) Clearly, we can see the changes through this research because they can compare their present communication system and past situation.
- 6) The research is connected with the older generation, family members, friends, relatives, parents, etc. So, it is related to their age with their older and younger generations. For this, we can see the connections from different sides. Also, which type of people they are comfortable to keep in touch with on Facebook.
- 7) There can be some obstacles and negative impacts (for example- addiction for it) on them, where we can try to help them. And though we know, we will be able to see the changes, we are not clear about the exact outcomes. But if we get to know the changes in the older generation and see that our purposes are fulfilling, then we will understand that we can accomplish our goals and track our progress.
- 8) We can do an in-depth interview. Seek available data online and from other sources. Also, we can gather data not only from traditional sources but also from previous research done on this topic. With that data, we can achieve our primary goal.
- 9) We have set our area and exact social media platform and know with whom we will do the research. So, we hope to reach our goal in a realistic time.

⁹ <http://dspace.daffodilvarsity.edu.bd:8080/handle/123456789/7463>

1.5. Research Questions-

- 1) What changes in communication are we seeing in their generation?
- 2) What kind of changes are their generation seeing in themselves?
- 3) What are they doing to cope with the changes?
- 4) What are the positive outcomes of this change for them?
- 5) What are the barriers they are facing? Is it difficult to use?
- 6) What facilities are they having now that they did not have before the change?
- 7) What positive, enjoyable, educative, and creative things do they see by using Facebook?
- 8) What more changes do they feel that they need?
- 9) What was their experience at the very beginning and now?
- 10) What are the feelings of those not involved in this platform in their generation? Are they facing any obstacles?
- 11) What are the ways they get involved and use the platform?
- 12) What do they think about their addiction and negative impacts?
- 13) What are the differences they see in communicating via Facebook and in real life?
- 14) Is it just a waste of time for the maximum of them?

1.6. Scopes and Limitations-

Scopes-

- 1) We can understand how the change happened and is still happening from their perspective.
- 2) Can know the problems they are facing about this new change and try to help them.
- 3) Can measure the positive or negative impacts. For this they will be able to manage using social media more intelligently.

Limitations-

- 1) Not everyone of the older adults who use Facebook will open up about their feelings and change.
- 2) Every one of them do not interact in the same way in the case of social media use, so they might get some questions unfamiliar and cannot answer them correctly.
- 3) As they are also new to this kind of communication change, maybe they will not be relevant to some features and cannot talk directly about them.

2. Literature Review-

After collecting five scholarly research paper online, we have reviewed them and tried to find out the relevance with our research topic. We have found both local and global research papers on older adult's social media use, compared and related with our research topic- *"Change of communication system among older generation in Dhaka by using Facebook"*

- 1) In a research paper named- *"Understanding and Changing Older Adults' Perceptions and Learning of Social-Media"*, their **aim** is to find out how the older adults are learning and understanding social media and to see the changes and from their perception. If they are seeing it as an educational platform and the effects of using it. And to see the positive and negative sides of it.

Methodology and Sample- They have used a semi-structured weekly method where there were open ended discussions. It was done in a specific age group (61-83 years) and they chose around 10 people to each participate in each session. And not everyone has the same internet experiences. Also, they used the *Inductive Thematic Analysis* for analyzing the data.

Results- For the people who do not use social-media at all, they think it has more negative impacts than positive. For those who use it- it is difficult to use for some, they want to learn more about it and are interested in using it. Some of them have privacy issues as well.

- 2) Another research paper titled- *"The Impact of Facebook on the Quality of Life of Senior Citizens in Cape Town"*, the **aim** is to see the effect of Facebook use on the quality of life (QOL) of older persons in Cape Town. The study used a positivist approach as the theoretical lens for evaluating how Facebook affects the QOL of elderly adults in Cape Town. The study also discovered that respondents predominantly utilized Facebook to keep socially involved with their friends and family, which adds enjoyment to their life. Also, to see how they use it.

“The results support previous research on social media use by the elderly, indicating that social media is used primarily to stay connected with friends and family and not to create new ties or relationships.” (Rylands & Belle, 2018)¹⁰

Methodology and Sample- They directly questioned the respondents about their usage of Facebook. The questionnaire was anonymous which was used to obtain quantitative data. They have used non-probability sample and stratified sample. It was also done in a specific age group (60 years or older) of **Cape Town**, who have general skills and know how to use social networking sites.

Results- The results of the data analysis show that there is a substantial association between the usage of Facebook and the QOL of older adults in Cape Town. As a result, the researcher can reject the null hypothesis that there is no association between Facebook use and older persons' QOL in Cape Town.

They found- how senior people in Cape Town use Facebook, why predominantly they use Facebook for and how their QOL is affected by using it.

3) In- “Early Prediction of Psychological Risk Factors of Addiction to Social Media among Older Generation Users in Bangladesh”, the **aim** is to know the older generation's internet use. Positive and negative impacts on them. Specially, how it can create negative impacts such as- their addiction level can cause problems, not knowing enough about the difference between authentic and fake, causing mental risk and health problems, distracting from real social life and so on.

“But the older generation is learning how to use the internet for 4-5 years and they are learning on their own. Which is creating multiple problems because they don't know the guideline for using the internet or how can the internet be useful for them or harmful for them.” (Zaman, Shoshi, & Nakib, 2021)¹¹

Methodology and Sample- They used data mining process and some other domains too. For data collecting they have used Google Forms to collect manually. They collected all of the data from close ones. Then they have processed with excel sheet and Tree algorithm, and used- SVM, DF and RF to classify the data. And they showed a graphical model to present their methodology and did a survey.

Results- By doing this research they found the change of older generations thinking, their dependency and addiction level. Also, they think it is possible to bring them into a healthy, normal society.

4) Another research paper- “Cognitive Effects of Social Media Use: A Case of Older Adults”, the **aim** is to look at how much social media is a part of adult life during their leisure time. In this way, in the midst of their daily activities, some time is seen as an extension of time due to social media activities.

Also to see the social benefits, engagements and everyday well-being by using social media.

“PEW Research reported recently that about one-third of all adults over the age of 65 years

¹⁰ https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-319-59111-7_60?fbclid=IwAR1Hueyuxbn95JPeXG69IbmY7PLiGFqHWcTyJH4B5pCf0wOO9HdCBUSYN4

¹¹ <http://dspace.daffodilvarsity.edu.bd:8080/handle/123456789/7463>

reported using social media.” (Anderson & Perrin, 2017)¹²

“Platforms like Facebook and Twitter assist individuals to enhance their social connection (Grieve, Indian, Witteveen, Anne Tolan, & Marrington, 2013), help lonely people gain social support (Vitak & Ellison, 2013), and help students to develop social capital.” (Ellison, Steinfield, & Lampe, 2007)¹³

Methodology and Sample- They did an extensive four-week test on the people over the age of 65. Data were collected on their usage of social media. Although the test started with 47 samples, 37 participants finally participated. Of these, 67.6% are females and 32.4% are males. The average age of 23 female and 11 male samples was 8.5 years.

Results- The results of both groups are correct but there is a slight difference between them. At present, the process of getting content is going on keeping in mind the needs of such audiences. This will expand the internet world for the elderly.

5) In- “Digital or in person: The Relationship Between Mode of Interpersonal Communication During COVID-19 Pandemic and Mental Health in Older Adults From 27 Countries”, The **aim** of this research is how COVID-19 pandemic have changed the modes of communication among older adults and how it influenced in their mental health. How using different modes of interpersonal communication affected on them mentally. To find out if the effect is positive or negative. Also, this research will find out, how much have it affected to them to interact with everyone digitally. By doing this research we will get to know about older adult’s- change of social communication pattern, their psychological consequences and how they have maintained their relationships during the pandemic.

“A recent longitudinal study showed that, in general, the size and structure of older adults’ social networks are stable over time.” (Conrwell et al.,2021) ¹⁴

Methodology and Sample- The data were collected from a representative cohort. They have done statistical analysis too. And there was a part of a specific questionnaire among people aged 50 and older. It was a multidisciplinary and cross-national longitudinal survey aged 50 and older.

Results- Both digital and in-person communication were used during communicating with their children and their mental health were related on this. Same goes for close ones. But for most case, they it affected positively while they communicated in-person, it is better for their mental health. And they also found some unique benefits of it.

¹² <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/2056305118787203>

¹³ <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/2056305118787203>

¹⁴ <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/10748407211031980>

By reviewing other research, we can see similarities and differences. But all of them are quite relevant to our topic.

In these researches, they focus on the older generation's communication change, effects on them about using it, their feelings and perceptions, negative and positive impacts, addictions, using literacy and so on. So, objectives are actually related to our topic.

Though methodologies and samplings are different. For our topic, we have decided to do a quantitative method by doing a survey. And the sampling is cluster sampling of Probability sample. We have chosen this method and sample because by doing a survey we can reach our goal easily. To see the change from older adult's perception, we can collect huge data from a specific age group.

In these researches they have used- semi-structured weekly method, anonymous questionnaire, open ended questions, data mining process, algorithms, statistical analysis, weekly extensive tests and so on.

Some of the research did a survey which is relevant to ours.

And the results show how much they have been able to fulfill their objectives. They found how many are interested or not interested in using social-media, what kind of impacts can be seen in these people for using it, how they use it, level of their addiction, which one they prefer more-digital or in-person etc. By our topic, we also want to know about these kinds of changes.

3. Research Design

3.1. Approach-

For doing our research, we choose to do it by Qualitative Method. It could be better for the researcher if he collects data by creating a comfortable and short distance with the people, he/she is communicating with for the research.

3.2. Methodology-

If we want to do the research by Qualitative Method, we can choose the In-depth Interview as the methodology. Because we want to know the feelings about the change and for this, we want to do a deeper analysis of our respondents.

In-depth Interview will give us the scope to hear their side of stories and they will become comfortable telling us that way. So, it will be just like a conversation between the researcher and the respondent but the researcher will analyze the story by the respondent's behavior and with what they are saying.

It can be done by a semi-structure method, where the researcher can ask what he/she desired to know about his/her chosen topic and also can ask other questions which he want to ask while the

conversation is going on to be clear in the topic. By this, the respondent can also become interested in telling their stories, give the researcher an idea of what they think from their perspectives and will interact better. And the researcher can analyze more deeply.

3.3. Population and Sampling-

We will do the research inside Dhaka city and the people we will reach for our desired question's answer would be the people in the urban area. We can divide our areas inside Dhaka. For example- we can research in Dhanmondi, Mohammadpur, Banani, Uttara, Gulshan and other such areas and choose a few people from each area inside the city. It would be done in- men, women and others who know how to operate the internet and different apps. And will be done on the people who are aged 45 and above. And because we want to know the change by using Facebook, we should reach mostly to those who use this app regularly and feel the change.

Because we have chosen the Qualitative method's In-depth Interview, our sample can be- Quota Sampling (non-probability sampling). Quota sampling will allow us to investigate deeply in a specific subgroup and their characteristics more clearly. For our research topic, we are doing it for a specific aged people and want to know the changes from their perspective. So, the data we want to collect can be collected by this sampling from a specific criteria of people and by knowing only from them.

3.4. Timeframe-

We can do the whole research in a year. But we have to collect our data face to face because we have chosen In-depth interview method and it can take time to know who is actually interested in talking about this topic. Also, it will take time to make the questionnaire because it should be suitable for any people in the age limit. We can create an approximate timeframe for doing the research.

Background data collection- 2 months

Literature Review- 1 month

Data collection- 3 or 4 months, because we are doing In-depth interview and the Quota sampling which can take time.

Data processing and analysis- 2 months

Writing final findings- 2 months

Total- So, we will need about ***10-11 months*** approximately.

3.5. Budget-

The approximate budget for the research-

Resources- 25,000 BDT.

Stationary- 30,000 BDT.

Operational Costs- 60,000 BDT.

Logistics- 30,000 BDT.

Transport- 25,000 BDT.

Remuneration for data collectors- 30,000 BDT.

Miscellaneous- 10,000 BDT.

Total- Around **2.1 lacks** BDT.

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